USER MANUAL / OCTOBER 2026

Greek to Greeklish Renamer

Rename Greek filenames and folders.
Preview first. Confirm every change.

Folder selection / Optional subfolders / CSV undo log

v1.2.1 / OPEN SOURCE / PYTHON 3.10+

Created by Dimitris Laidis

github.com/DimitrisLai/Greek-to-greeklish-renamer

01 / Get started

Greek to Greeklish Renamer converts Greek letters in filenames and folder names into Latin characters. It works on the names of items, not their contents.

Requirements

- Windows 10/11 for the double-click launcher; Python **3.10 or newer** installed.
- No extra Python packages or internet connection needed to run the renamer.
- Rename permission for the chosen folder; keep a separate backup for important data.

Five easy steps

- Download and **extract** the Windows ZIP from GitHub Releases.
- Double-click **Run_Greek_to_Greeklish.cmd**.
- Paste a directory path, or press Enter to use the folder containing the script.
- Answer **Y** to include subfolders, or **N / Enter** to scan the selected folder only.
- Review the proposal. Type the exact word **YES** to apply or cancel otherwise.

What is in the Windows ZIP?

FILE	PURPOSE
rename_greek_to_greeklish.py	Main renaming program.
Run_Greek_to_Greeklish.cmd	Windows launcher; double-click to run.
User Manual / LICENSE / AUTHOR.txt	Instructions, license terms and author credit.

IMPORTANT

Do not run the launcher directly inside the ZIP preview. Extract the files first.

02 / Your first rename

Choose a folder and review the preview before changing any names. The Windows launcher keeps the console open when the program ends.

Example interactive session

```
GREEK TO GREEKLISH RENAMER v1.2.1
Folder path: D:\Music
Include subdirectories? [y/N]: n

  Ελληνικά.mp3  -->  Ellinika.mp3
  Μουσική.flac  -->  Mousiki.flac

Proposed changes: 2
Type YES to apply changes:
```

Confirmation rules

- The program does not rename anything before the confirmation prompt.
- **YES** (uppercase) approves the proposed rename operations.
- Press Enter or type anything else to cancel without renaming.
- For large folders, the on-screen preview displays up to **80** planned changes, plus a count of the rest.

AFTER RUNNING

The program reports the number renamed and writes a dated **greeklish_rename_log_*.csv** file in the selected folder. Keep the CSV for undo.

03 / Subfolders and scope

The program asks whether you want to include subdirectories. Each choice has a different effect on the scan.

ANSWER	WHAT HAPPENS
N or Enter	Only files directly inside the selected directory are examined; subfolders stay untouched.
Y	Files in nested folders are included. Greek-named subfolders are renamed after their contents.

Examples

```
D:\Music\Ελληνικά.mp3    -> D:\Music\Ellinika.mp3
D:\Music\Greek\Τραγούδι.mp3  -> ...\Tragoudi.mp3
```

Files only, even with recursive scanning

Use **--recursive --files-only** to inspect files in subfolders while keeping all directory names unchanged.

Names containing no Greek letters

- **English Song.mp3** stays exactly as it is.
- **Artist - Ελληνικό.mp3** is eligible because part of its name contains Greek letters.
- The application does not inspect lyrics, audio tags, photo contents or document text.

LINK PROTECTION

Symbolic links and Windows junctions/reparse points are skipped during traversal.

04 / Renaming examples

Greeklish spelling is approximate: the tool follows simplified ELOT 743 / ISO 843-inspired ASCII transcription rules.

ORIGINAL FILENAME	PROPOSED RESULT
Γιώργος Μαζωνάκης.mp3	Giorgos Mazonakis.mp3
Δημήτρης Κόκοτας.flac	Dimitris Kokotas.flac
DJ Set - Ελληνικά.mp3	DJ Set - Ellinika.mp3
Αυτοκίνητο.jpg	Aftokinito.jpg
English Song.mp3	Unchanged

What is preserved?

- Original file contents, file types and existing Latin text.
- File extensions such as **.mp3**, **.flac**, and **.jpg**.
- Spaces, punctuation and the relative folder structure, except eligible Greek names.

SPELLING LIMITATION

The program removes accents and uses simplified context rules. It is **not** a certified, reversible implementation of ELOT 743. Proper-name spellings may differ.

05 / Safety and conflicts

The renamer uses a preview-first design, but bulk renaming can affect applications or playlists that reference the original paths.

Safety behavior

- No changes without the exact YES confirmation (unless you intentionally use **--yes**).
- An existing file or folder is never deliberately replaced by the renamer.
- When a new Latin filename is already occupied, the tool adds a suffix such as **(2)** or **(3)**.
- Each successful operation is added to a UTF-8 CSV log, which can later be used for undo.
- Linked folders and Windows junctions are excluded.

Filename conflict example

EXISTING NAMES	RESULT
Ελληνικά.mp3 + Ellinika.mp3	Ellinika.mp3 stays; the Greek file is renamed to Ellinika (2).mp3.

BEFORE A LARGE RENAME

Run **--dry-run** first, back up important files, and close players, editors or sync programs using the folder.

06 / Undo and recovery

The program stores original and new relative paths in a dated CSV log after you confirm renaming.

How to restore original filenames

- Keep the original CSV file produced by the renaming run.
- Open Command Prompt or PowerShell where the Python script is located.
- Provide both the selected folder path and the CSV log path as shown below.
- Type **UNDO** at the confirmation prompt.

```
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:\Music"
  --undo "D:\Music\greeklish_rename_log_...csv"
```

What undo does and does not do

- Recorded changes are restored in reverse order, allowing renamed parent folders to be restored before their contents.
- If an original path is already occupied, that item is skipped rather than overwritten.
- Missing files, additional manual moves, and unrelated edits cannot be reliably undone from the CSV.
- Undo logs contain filenames/paths; check them before sharing publicly.

KEEP THE CSV

Do not delete the log until you have verified the renamed files and no longer need to restore their original names.

07 / Command-line reference

The supplied Windows launcher handles normal interactive use. Python command-line options support more precise or repeatable runs.

OPTION	EFFECT
--path "FOLDER"	Select a directory without the initial folder prompt.
--recursive	Include subdirectories without asking.
--no-recursive	Scan the selected folder only.
--files-only	Keep folder names unchanged while scanning files.
--dry-run	Show proposed changes without renaming anything.
--yes	Skip the confirmation prompt; use carefully.
--undo "CSV"	Restore from a previous CSV log.
--help / --version	Display command help or version information.

Read-only preview

```
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:\Music"
  --no-recursive --dry-run
```

POWER USERS

When neither --recursive nor --no-recursive is given, the program asks the subdirectory question even if --path is supplied.

08 / Troubleshooting

Most issues can be resolved by checking the selected folder, Python availability, file permissions or the preview output.

SYMPTOM	WHAT TO CHECK
Python not found	Install Python 3.10+; try py -3 or python in Command Prompt.
Nothing proposed	Check the path, Greek letters in names, and whether subfolders were included.
File in use / access denied	Close applications using the files and verify folder permissions.
Unexpected (2) suffix	Another item already uses the intended Latin filename.
Undo skips an item	Original path is occupied or the renamed file has been moved/missing.
Words look unusual	Simplified transliteration differs from some preferred personal spellings.

Project information

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Version 1.2.1 · Python 3.10+ · MIT License

github.com/DimitrisLai/Greek-to-greeklish-renamer

REPORTING AN ISSUE

Use GitHub Issues and include the version, Python/Windows version, exact message and a small example with invented filenames. Avoid sharing personal paths or full music libraries.